

19 — Classes (the component system)

This chapter defines every class, superseding the old four. Each of the **48 classes** is generated from the same component vocabulary used everywhere else in the book — weapon types (17-weapons.md), armor tiers (18-armor.md), and schools of magic (10-spell-list.md). Character creation (02-character-creation.md) points here for the roster.

How classes are generated

A class is a **legal combination of components**. Pick a template, fill its slots, and you have a class — that's the whole generator. Everything below is the rules that decide which combinations are legal and balanced.

The components

- Weapon types:** Light · Medium · Heavy · Ranged
- Armor tiers:** Light · Heavy · None
- Schools of magic:** Destruction · Conjururation · Alteration · Illusion · Restoration

The legal templates

Fighting classes (*no magic*):

Template	Slots
Armored	2 weapon types + 1 armor tier (light or heavy)
Naked weapon-master	3 weapon types + no armor

Magic classes (*cast from a pool; light or no armor only — heavy blocks casting*):

Template	Slots
Half-caster	1 school + 1 weapon type + light armor
Spellsword	2 schools + 1 martial weapon (medium/heavy) + no armor
Caster	2 schools + light armor
Full caster	3 schools + no armor

The build economy (the balance spine)

- Every class is built from exactly 3 components.** A component is *1 weapon type, 1 school, or 1 armor tier*.
- Baseline = **2 picks (weapons/schools) + an armor tier** = 3 components.
 - Going naked (no armor) buys a 3rd pick** but drops you to the lowest HP *and* Armor — the glass-cannon bargain.
 - Each component is a 2-perk track** — a *basic* perk and an *advanced* perk (the tracks below). You **unlock these as you level**, not at creation: a class's full kit is **6 perks**, gained one at a time across the campaign (03-progression.md).
 - On top of the components, every character gets **2 Signatures at level 1**: a **Racial Signature** (your ancestry trait, 02-character-creation.md) and a unique **Class Signature** (below). These are your identity from turn one.
 - A build is legal **iff it lands on 3 components** — still checkable by counting. And because the unlock schedule is fixed, **every character of a given level has the same number of abilities** (2 signatures + the perks unlocked so far).
 - No build exceeds 3 components.** So you can't have 2 schools *and* a weapon *and* armor (that's 4): a 2-school gish goes **naked** (the **Spellsword** — its weapon and spells share one stat, so being lightly built is fine), and an *armored* gish takes only **1 school** (the **Half-caster**). The armored 2-school war-mage simply doesn't exist — by design.

HP & primary ability

- HP rides the armor tier:** Heavy 10 + Might · Light 8 + Might · None 6 + Might . Per-level gain 1d6 + Might (1s/2s count as 3).

- Your class grants +1 to its primary ability.** Primary is set **by feel**: Might for medium/heavy weapons, Agility for light/ranged builds; Mind, Spirit, or Charisma (the **pool**) for casters. It is *not* a separate combination axis. A caster's pool also reflects the *source* of their magic — Mind for the studied, Spirit for the devoted, Charisma for the innate.
- Your primary powers everything.** Every weapon attack, weapon damage, and spell attack uses your one primary ability (06-attack-and-defense.md). A Mind-Battlemage's blade *and* its fire both run off Mind; a Might-Knight's everything runs off Might. One stat, whole character — which is what lets a gish wield a real weapon without splitting its ability investment.

The weight rules (what heavy gear costs)

- Heavy weapons are two-handed.** No shield, no off-hand. Medium and light are one-handed.
- No ranged weapons in heavy armor.** Heavy armor is the melee line — you cannot use bows, crossbows, or thrown weapons while wearing it. Archers and skirmishers live in light or no armor. (*This is why every heavy-armor class is a Might melee build — and why there's no tanky-archer.*)
- Set to Strike — heavy gear plants you.** On a turn where you **move and attack**:
 - wielding a **heavy weapon** *or* wearing **heavy armor** → that **attack is at disadvantage**;
 - wielding a heavy weapon *and* wearing heavy armor → you **can't do both: take your move *or* your attack this turn, not both.**

Stand your ground (use no movement) and you strike normally. (*Disadvantage is binary — 01-core-mechanic.md — so the "both heavy" case escalates to denial rather than stacking dice.*) This gives heavy gear a real cost without a speed stat: **heavy = the immovable melee anchor; light/none = mobile**. It also synergizes with the perks — heavy armor's **Bulwark** and heavy weapons reward planting; light armor's **Slip Away** rewards moving.

Spellcasting access

A magic class casts from one **pool** (level + Mind , level + Spirit , or level + Charisma), knows 2 cantrips + the spells-known table (09-magic.md), drawn from its accessible **schools** (10-spell-list.md). Cast freely in light or no armor; **heavy armor blocks casting** (so no magic class wears it). Casters are trained in casting (spell attack = d20 + pool + training).

Component perk tracks

Each component is a **2-perk track**: a **basic** perk and an **advanced** one. You unlock perks on your perk levels (3 / 6 / 9 then 12 / 15 / 18 — 03-progression.md), basics first; a component's **advanced** perk requires you already hold its **basic** perk. By level 18 you hold all 6 perks of your 3 components.

Weapon tracks

Component	Basic	Advanced
Light	Sneak Strike — once per turn, when you attack with advantage or an ally is adjacent to your target, deal +1d6 on a hit.	Shadowstrike — your Sneak Strike die becomes +2d6 ; the first time each combat you hit a creature that hasn't acted yet, it's +3d6 .
Medium	Riposte — once per round, when a creature misses you in melee, immediately make one weapon attack against it.	Riposte Mastery — Riposte triggers when an enemy hits or misses you in melee (still 1/round), and the riposte attack has advantage .
Heavy	Cleave — when your attack drops a creature to 0 HP, make another attack against a different target in reach, same action.	Reaving Sweep — once per turn deal +1d10 on a hit; and Cleave now also chains off a hit that drops a target below half HP , not only to 0.
Ranged	Deadeye — your ranged attacks ignore half-cover. Once per turn, if your target is at Far range, deal +1d6 on a hit.	Piercing Volley — once per turn your ranged attack strikes every creature in a line to your target (roll each separately) and ignores all cover.

Armor tracks

Component	Basic	Advanced
Light armor	Slip Away — when an adjacent enemy takes an action that isn't attacking you, move up to half your Speed without provoking.	Evasion — when an area effect rolls against your Armor, a hit deals half , a miss deals none ; and Slip Away no longer needs the enemy to skip attacking you.
Heavy armor	Bulwark — allies adjacent to you have +1 Armor . <i>(A flat bonus to a static defense — permitted; the "no stacking +1" rule governs d20 rolls.)</i>	Immovable — you can't be moved, knocked Prone , or Grappled against your will, and your Bulwark bonus rises to +2 Armor .

School tracks

Component	Basic	Advanced
Destruction	Devastation — once per turn, reroll 1s and 2s on a Destruction spell's damage dice.	Overload — once per rest, maximize all the damage dice of one Destruction spell you cast.
Conjuration	Master Summoner — your summons get +1 to attack and last 2 extra rounds (see Summoning, 10-spell-list.md).	Greater Binding — your summons gain +1d6 to attacks and +10 HP ; your bound weapons step up one die (1d8 → 1d10).
Alteration	Arcane Ward — while you have 1+ mana , you gain +2 Armor .	Greater Ward — your Arcane Ward rises to +3 Armor , and once per rest you may extend a +3 ward to a touched ally for 1 minute.
Illusion	Beguiling — creatures roll at disadvantage to resist or break free of your Illusion effects.	Shatter Will — once per rest, a creature in Near rolls its lowest mental defense (Mind/Spirit/Charisma) vs. your spell attack or is Stunned until the end of its next turn.
Restoration	Divine Touch — as your action, touch a creature to heal 1d6 + pool . Usable 1 + pool times per rest.	Greater Mending — your Divine Touch heals 2d6 + pool and may be used at Near range (no touch needed).

Signatures (your identity)

- Two unique abilities define who you are. Both are granted at **level 1** and never have to be earned:
- Class Signature** — the one thing only your class does, tuned to ≈ a perk in power (unique, not stronger). The 48 are listed under *Class signatures* below. *(These were the old "override" perks — they now stand on their own at level 1 instead of swapping for a component perk.)*
 - Racial Signature** — your ancestry's trait (02-character-creation.md).

At the **level-20 capstone**, your Class Signature **ascends** to a master version — as a rule of thumb: double its dice, drop a "once per rest" limit, or widen its range or targets — but **never a second action**. The GM signs off on the upgrade in the spirit of the original. *(Per-class ascensions are a content pass; until then, use this rule.)*

How the original four map

Old class	New class (#)	Components	Basic-rung perks
Warrior	Knight (#9)	Medium + Heavy · Heavy armor · Might	Riposte · Cleave · Bulwark
Scout	Ranger (#3)	Light + Ranged · Light armor · Agility	Sneak Strike · Deadeye · Slip Away
Mage	Mage (#34)	Conjuration + Illusion · Light armor · Mind	Master Summoner · Beguiling · Slip Away
Priest	Priest (#37)	Alteration + Restoration · Light armor · Spirit	Arcane Ward · Divine Touch · Slip Away

*(The perks shown are each component's **basic** rung — unlocked over levels 3/6/9, with the matching **advanced** rung following at 12/15/18. Each class also has its **Class Signature** plus a **Racial Signature** from level 1.)*

Building a character (revised step 2 of 02-character-creation.md)

- Pick a class** → **+1** to its primary, weapon/armor/school training, HP tier, mana (if any), your **Class Signature**, and the **component perk tracks** you'll unlock as you level.
- Ancestry (**+1 + Racial Signature**).
- Background (+1 training).
- Three trainings (4 if Human).
- Defenses, equipment, spells.

The 48-class roster

⚔ **Fighting — armored (2 weapons + 1 armor)**

#	Class	Weapons	Primary	Armor	HP
1	Duelist	Light + Medium	Might	Light	Mid
2	Reaver	Light + Heavy	Might	Light	Mid
3	Ranger	Light + Ranged	Agility	Light	Mid
4	Berserker	Medium + Heavy	Might	Light	Mid
5	Skirmisher	Medium + Ranged	Might	Light	Mid
6	Outrider	Heavy + Ranged	Might	Light	Mid
7	Sentinel	Light + Medium	Might	Heavy	High
8	Vanguard	Light + Heavy	Might	Heavy	High
9	Knight	Medium + Heavy	Might	Heavy	High

(Heavy-armor classes carry no ranged weapon, per weight rule ②.)

✂ **Fighting — naked weapon-master (3 weapons, no armor) — HP Low**

#	Class	Weapons	Primary
10	Gladiator	Light + Medium + Heavy	Might
11	Blademaster	Light + Medium + Ranged	Might
12	Marauder	Light + Heavy + Ranged	Might
13	Weaponmaster	Medium + Heavy + Ranged	Might

🔮 **Half-caster (1 school + light weapon + light armor) — HP Mid**

#	Class	School	Pool
14	Spellblade	Destruction	Mind
15	Adept	Conjuration	Mind
16	Warden	Alteration	Spirit
17	Trickster	Illusion	Charisma
18	Acolyte	Restoration	Spirit

- Assign abilities +3 / +2 / +1 / +1 / +0 .

🧙 Spellsword (2 schools + martial weapon, no armor) — HP Low

#	Class	Schools	Pool
19	Death Knight	Conjuration + Destruction	Spirit
20	Battlemage	Alteration + Destruction	Mind
21	Hexblade	Destruction + Illusion	Charisma
22	Paladin	Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
23	Spellforged	Alteration + Conjuration	Mind
24	Witch-blade	Conjuration + Illusion	Charisma
25	Wraith Knight	Conjuration + Restoration	Spirit
26	Mindblade	Alteration + Illusion	Mind
27	Cleric-Knight	Alteration + Restoration	Spirit
28	Sword-Bard	Illusion + Restoration	Charisma

🌟 Caster (2 schools + light armor) — HP Mid

#	Class	Schools	Pool
29	Warlock	Conjuration + Destruction	Charisma
30	Sorcerer	Alteration + Destruction	Charisma
31	Mentalist	Destruction + Illusion	Mind
32	Templar	Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
33	Artificer	Alteration + Conjuration	Mind
34	Mage	Conjuration + Illusion	Mind
35	Shaman	Conjuration + Restoration	Spirit
36	Enchanter	Alteration + Illusion	Charisma
37	Priest	Alteration + Restoration	Spirit
38	Bard	Illusion + Restoration	Charisma

🏰 Full caster (3 schools, no armor) — HP Low

#	Class	Schools	Pool
39	Elementalist	Alteration + Conjuration + Destruction	Mind
40	Archmage	Conjuration + Destruction + Illusion	Mind
41	Necromancer	Conjuration + Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
42	Spellmystic	Alteration + Destruction + Illusion	Mind
43	Oracle	Alteration + Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
44	Witch	Destruction + Illusion + Restoration	Charisma
45	Mystic	Alteration + Conjuration + Illusion	Charisma
46	Druid	Alteration + Conjuration + Restoration	Spirit
47	Spiritualist	Conjuration + Illusion + Restoration	Spirit
48	Seer	Alteration + Illusion + Restoration	Spirit

Class signatures — descriptions & abilities

Each class's one-line identity and its unique **Class Signature**, granted at level 1 (the ability marked ↪). 🌶️ = flagged for playtest.

Fighting — armored

- **1 · Duelist** — *A nimble blade-dancer who turns a foe's commitment into an opening.* ↪ **En Garde:** mark a creature you hit in melee; while marked it has disadvantage attacking anyone but you, and you have advantage on Riposte against it.
- **2 · Reaver** — *A savage raider who fights harder as the wounds pile up.* ↪ **Bloodlust:** while below half HP, your melee attacks deal +1d6 and you're immune to Frightened.
- **3 · Ranger** — *A wilderness hunter who marks prey and never loses it.* ↪ **Hunter's Mark:** mark a creature (free, 1/turn); your attacks against it ignore cover and deal +1d6. Re-marks on a kill.
- **4 · Berserker** — *A reckless warrior who trades skin for slaughter.* ↪ **Rage** (free, 1/rest, 1 min): melee attacks +1d6 and advantage on Might, but attacks against you have advantage.
- **5 · Skirmisher** — *A mobile soldier who strikes and slips away.* ↪ **Hit and Run:** after you attack, move up to half your Speed without provoking.
- **6 · Outrider** — *A roving heavy hitter who softens foes at range, then closes.* ↪ **Overwhelm:** when you hit with a ranged attack, your next melee attack vs. that target has advantage (and vice-versa).
- **7 · Sentinel** — *An immovable guardian who punishes anyone who ignores them.* ↪ **Guardian's Wrath:** when an enemy in reach attacks an ally (not you), immediately make a melee attack against it.
- **8 · Vanguard** — *The first through the breach, an armored spearhead.* ↪ **Breach:** as your action, charge your full Speed in a line and attack; on a hit, knock the target Prone. (Note: as a double-heavy build, this is its move-or-attack turn.)
- **9 · Knight** — *A disciplined heavy fighter, the wall the line forms around. (the old Warrior)* ↪ **Second Wind:** once per rest, as part of any action, regain 1d6 + level HP.

Fighting — naked weapon-master

- **10 · Gladiator** — *A crowd-pleasing arena fighter who feeds on the kill.* ↪ **Adrenaline:** each time you drop a creature to 0 HP, your next attack this round deals +1d6.
- **11 · Blademaster** — *A peerless weapon artist who answers steel with steel.* ↪ **Deflect:** once per round, when hit, reduce the damage by 1d8 + primary.
- **12 · Marauder** — *A brutal pillager who finishes the wounded without mercy.* ↪ **Pillage:** your attacks against creatures below half HP deal +1d8.
- **13 · Weaponmaster** — *A master of every armament — devastating, but exposed.* ↪ **Stance:** at the start of your turn, choose +1d6 damage or +2 Armor until your next turn.

Half-caster

- **14 · Spellblade** — *A warrior-mage who sheathes fire in steel.* ↪ **Spellstrike:** on a weapon hit, spend 1 mana to add 1d8 Destruction damage (your element).
- **15 · Adept** — *A novice summoner backed by a conjured ally.* ↪ **Bonded Blade** (1/rest, no mana): conjure a spectral weapon that fights on your turn for the encounter (your spell attack, 1d8).
- **16 · Warden** — *A protector who hardens flesh against harm.* ↪ **Stoneflesh:** as your action, grant yourself or a touched ally +3 Armor (ongoing, 1 min).
- **17 · Trickster** — *A deceiver who strikes from a fold in perception.* ↪ **Vanishing Act:** once per round after you attack, briefly vanish — attacks against you have disadvantage and your next attack has advantage.
- **18 · Acolyte** — *A field medic who mends as they fight.* ↪ **Battle Prayer:** once per rest, every ally in Near regains 1d6 + pool HP.

Spellsword (naked, 2 schools + a martial weapon)

- **19 · Death Knight** — *A grim warrior wreathed in necrotic power and raised servants.* ↪ **Soul Reap:** when you drop a creature with a weapon attack, regain 1d6 mana (max your pool).
- **20 · Battlemage** — *An armored-in-magic blaster who fights in the thick of it.* ↪ **Runic Weapon:** your weapon attacks deal +1d6 of a chosen element (fire/frost/shock). An at-will rider — no extra action.
- **21 · Hexblade** — *A cursed blade that unmakes mind and body together.* ↪ **Hex:** mark a creature (free, 1/turn); your spells and attacks vs. it deal +1d6 and it has disadvantage on its first attack each round.
- **22 · Paladin** — *A holy warrior of smiting wrath and mending light.* ↪ **Divine Smite:** on a weapon hit, spend 1–3 mana to deal 1d8 radiant per mana.

- **23 · Spellforged** — *An artificer-warrior clad in conjured arms and wards.* ↳ **Arsenal** (1/rest): conjure a bound weapon (1d10 , your spell attack) and +2 Armor for the encounter.
- **24 · Witch-blade** — *A fey-touched duelist flanked by phantasms.* ↳ **Phantom Double** (1/rest): an illusory twin grants you disadvantage-to-be-hit until first struck, and once grants you advantage.
- **25 · Wraith Knight** — *A deathless sentinel who siphons life to endure.* ↳ **Lifedrain:** on a weapon hit, spend 1 mana to heal yourself 1d6 .
- **26 · Mindblade** — *A psionic warrior whose blade is an extension of will.* ↳ **Psychic Lash:** once per turn, your weapon attack targets **Mind** (psychic); on a hit the target has disadvantage on its next attack.
- **27 · Cleric-Knight** — *A consecrated guardian who shields and heals in armor of faith.* ↳ **Aegis:** once per round, when an ally in Near is hit, reduce that damage by 1d6 + pool .
- **28 · Sword-Bard** — *A blade-singer who bolsters allies and beguiles foes.* ↳ **Battle Hymn:** as your action, allies in Near get advantage and enemies in Near disadvantage on their next attack.

Caster

- **29 · Warlock** — *A pact-caster who hurls eldritch fire and calls servitors.* ↳ **Eldritch Blast:** signature cantrip — 1d10 force at Far, 0 mana; 1d12 while you have no mana left.
- **30 · Sorcerer** — *A wild innate caster who bends and amplifies their magic.* ↳ **Overcharge:** once per turn, spend 1 extra mana on a damage spell to maximize one of its dice.
- **31 · Mentalist** — *A mind-burning caster who shatters thought and body.* ↳ **Mind Spike** (1/rest): a creature in Near rolls Mind vs. your spell attack or is Stunned 1 round + takes 2d6 psychic.
- **32 · Templar** — *A militant healer who scourges foes and saves allies.* ↳ **Radiant Surge:** when you cast a Destruction spell, heal an ally in Near 1d6 .
- **33 · Artificer** — *A maker who conjures tools, turrets, and constructs.* ↳ **Turret** (1/rest): conjure a construct (acts on your turn, ranged 1d8 , 13 HP) for the encounter.
- **34 · Mage** — *The classic arcanist: summons, glamours, and clever control. (the old Mage)* ↳ **Arcane Recovery:** once per rest, regain 1d4 + level mana.
- **35 · Shaman** — *A spirit-speaker who calls ancestral aid and mends the tribe.* ↳ **Ancestral Spirit** (1/rest): summon a guardian (acts on your turn, melee 1d8 , or heals an adjacent ally 1d6).
- **36 · Enchanter** — *A subtle manipulator of minds and matter.* ↳ **Dominate** (1/rest): a creature you've Charmed obeys one command — move + one action — on its turn.
- **37 · Priest** — *A devoted healer and warder of the faithful. (the old Priest)* ↳ **Intercession:** once per rest, when an ally in Near would drop to 0 HP, they drop to 1 instead and you heal them 1d6 + pool .

- **38 · Bard** — *A charismatic performer who inspires allies and bewitches foes.* ↳ **Inspiration** (free, 1+pool /rest): give an ally advantage on their next roll of any kind.

Full caster

- **39 · Elementalist** — *A master of raw elements — fire, frost, and stone.* ↳ **Attunement:** each turn choose fire (+1d6), frost (halve target Speed), or stone (+2 Armor to you) on your Destruction spells.
- **40 · Archmage** — *The pinnacle arcanist — devastating and endlessly versatile.* ↳ **Spell Mastery:** choose one Lesser spell you know; once per rest, cast it without paying mana.
- **41 · Necromancer** — *A death-mage who raises the fallen and drains the living.* ↳ **Raise Dead** (1/rest): raise a slain creature in Near as a thrall (acts on your turn, 1d8) for the encounter.
- **42 · Spellmystic** — *A reality-warper blending force, fire, and falsehood.* ↳ **Warp:** once per round, as a free action, teleport up to Near range.
- **43 · Oracle** — *A seer channeling divine foresight, wrath, and healing.* ↳ **Foresight:** once per round, force any creature in sight to reroll a d20; you pick which result stands.
- **44 · Witch** — *A hedge-sorceress of curses, hexes, and old remedies.* ↳ **Curse:** mark a creature (free, 1/turn); it has disadvantage on defenses vs. your spells, which deal +1d6 against it.
- **45 · Mystic** — *An enigmatic caster of wards, phantoms, and bound spirits.* ↳ **Astral Step** (1/rest): become incorporeal until your next turn — move through anything, can't be grappled, attacks vs. you have disadvantage.
- **46 · Druid** — *A keeper of the wilds who shapes nature and calls beasts.* ↳ **Wild Shape** (1/rest): become a beast (GM's equivalent pick) up to 10 min; revert at your HP when it drops. 🍌
- **47 · Spiritualist** — *A medium who walks with spirits and mends through them.* ↳ **Possession** (1/rest): a willing ally in Near immediately takes a full extra turn, guided by a spirit. 🍌
- **48 · Seer** — *A prophet who sees the strands of fate and reweaves them.* ↳ **Ward of Fate:** once per round, when an ally in Near is hit, you may cause the attack to miss instead.

What this system doesn't have

- Subclasses or multiclassing (the combinations replace both).
- A separate martial resource pool (at-will weapons are the martial engine).
- A speed stat for armor (weight rule ③ handles it via tempo, not Speed).
- Per-class bespoke rules beyond your component tracks + 2 signatures.
- More than **3 components** on any build (the balance invariant — the 6 perks unlock from those 3 components over levels).